Start here

A lean plan built on the 5-step path

The 5-step path

Source: Olly Richards, How I Would Learn Italian (if I could start over in 2026). Watch it once. Everything in this pack maps to one of the five steps; nothing else is included.

Step	Principle	Your file
1	Lean hard on cognates	01-Cognates-and-Grammar-Lookup.pdf
2	Read with audio	02-Read-with-Audio.pdf
3	Let grammar come to you (look it up only when you need it)	01-Cognates-and-Grammar-Lookup.pdf, last section
4	Speak before you're ready (mingle with Italians)	03-Speak-Now.pdf and 05-Everyday-Basics.pdf (numbers, time, days, months, weather)
5	Build an Italian home (people, TV, podcasts, vlogs)	04-Italian-Home.pdf

Daily 30 minutes

- **10 min Read with audio** (one story section, file 02).
- **10 min Speak**: say today's chunks and one scenario out loud (file 03).
- **10 min Italian home**: one video or podcast segment (file 04).
- Grammar: **zero planned minutes**. Only look something up when a sentence blocks you.

Everything here is free

All resources linked are free to use. Some sites also sell apps, courses or memberships (MeloLingua app, The Fable Cottage membership, Italy Made Easy courses, the video author's paid courses). You never need them.